- Loosen the garments to allow free movements of the chest and abdomen.
- Frequent suction is required to prevent the pooling of secretion in the patients pharynx.
- If necessary insert oral airway for easy breathing.

❖ Maintenance of fluid & electrolyte balance and nutrition:

- The diet must contain an adequate supply of all nutrients required for life. Nutrition may be supplied by intravenous fluids or gastric tube feeding. (refer practicals)
- Administer prescribed intravenous fluids with electrolytes and vitamins (refer practicals).
- Maintain Intake and output chart accurately.
- Monitor vital signs and record.

❖ Maintenance of personal hygiene and care of pressure areas including prevention of foot drop:

- Sponging is performed as frequently as necessary
- Keep the skin dry, clean and free of moisture to prevent bed sore.
- Apply back care every 4th hourly and 2nd hourly position changing to relieve pressure on pressure areas.
- Clip the nails
- Range of motion exercises atleast 4 times a day.
- Cleanse the mouth with the prescribed solution every two hours and apply emollients to prevent parotitis.
- Irrigate the eye with sterile prescribed solution to remove discharge and debris.
- Clean the ear with swab and dry carefully, especially behind the ears.
- The bed linen must be kept wrinkle free and dry.
- Side railing on both sides are helpful to protect the patient.
- The feet should be kept at right angles to the legs with help of pillow or sand bags to prevent foot drop.

❖ Promoting elimination:

- If the patient is observed for any sign of urinary incontinency, retention and constipation, report to the physician.
- If the patient has incontinence of urine – provide bedpan or catheterization can be done according to Doctor's order to record the accurate output. (refer practicals).
- If the patient has retention of urine, apply gentle pressure over the bladder region. It will help in partially emptying the bladder.
- If the patient is constipated, a glycerine suppository or enema is advised according to Doctor's prescription.
- Perineal care, vaginal douch, catheter care to be provided (refer practicals).
- Palpate the abdomen for distension.

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